

Maven Toys Sales Analysis Business Intelligence Report

Prepared by

Pallab Dey

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Executive Summary

Maven Toys operates across 50 stores in Mexico, spanning four location formats -Downtown, Commercial, Residential, and Airport. This report analyzes sales performance across **2022–2023**, covering \$14M in total revenue, 829K transactions, and 1M units sold, using a five-page interactive Power BI dashboard built on SQL-processed data.

The business delivered strong growth in 2023, with revenue up **30.9%** and units sold increasing **40.8%**. However, Gross Margin declined **11.3%** to **27.8%**. The business is scaling volume faster than it is protecting margins, and this report identifies exactly where and why.

Key Highlights:

- **Downtown** dominance is a concentration risk. Downtown stores generate **\$8.2M**, which is more than double that of all other formats combined. A single format disruption could materially impact total revenue.
- **Electronics** is the most profitable category at **44.6% margin** yet holds only **15.55% revenue share**. The highest-value category is being underleveraged while lower margin categories like **Toys (21.2%)** dominate shelf and sales volume.
- One product carries disproportionate revenue weight. **Lego Bricks** alone generates **\$2.4M**, that is nearly **17%** of total revenue, creating significant SKU-level concentration risk.
- **Airport stores** are the margin efficiency leaders at **29.3%**, outperforming all other formats yet they remain the lowest volume channel. This model has untapped scaling potential.
- Saturday accounts for **19.8%** of weekly revenue, while **April** was the peak performing month.
- **20 SKUs** are currently **out of stock across all locations**, with several stores including La Paz 1 and Mexicali 2, carrying **≥4** products at stockout risk. Active revenue is being lost today.

Strategic Opportunity: Maven Toys has achieved impressive volume and revenue growth; it must urgently address the declining margin trend and stockout issues to improve sustainable profitability.

Business Problem & Objectives

Background

Maven Toys is experiencing strong growth across its Mexican retail network but internal performance data reveals a widening gap between revenue growth and profitability. Leadership requires a clear, data driven view of what is working, what is at risk, and where to act next.

The Core Business Problem

Revenue growth is being driven by volume, not value. With gross margin declining **-11.3%** while units sold grew **+40.8%**, the business faces a structural profitability challenge. Without understanding which products, categories, and store formats are driving or dragging margin, growth investments risk being misallocated.

Project Objectives

This analysis was designed to answer four operational and strategic questions:

1. **Performance Diagnosis** — Understand the true drivers of YTD revenue growth and identify where margin is being lost.
2. **Product Portfolio Optimization** — Identify which categories and SKUs offer the best revenue to margin balance and which require strategic intervention.
3. **Store Network Efficiency** — Benchmark store performance across formats and geographies to identify star performers, underperformers, and scalable models.
4. **Behavioral & Seasonal Intelligence** — Uncover demand patterns by time, day and category to improve inventory planning, staffing, and promotional timing.

Scope

- **Period:** 2022 – 2023 (YTD)
- **Geography:** Mexico — 50 stores across multiple cities
- **Formats:** Downtown, Commercial, Residential, Airport
- **Tool Stack:** SQL (data cleaning & aggregation) → Power BI (interactive dashboard, 5 pages)

Dashboard Page 1: Overview



This page gives a company-wide snapshot of Maven Toys' performance across all stores, categories, and time periods. It includes five KPI cards at the top, a quarterly revenue and gross profit chart, revenue by store location & category and a monthly revenue trend comparing 2022 vs 2023.

[Note on 2023 Data: This analysis covers data from **2022 (full year)** and **2023 up to September (Q3 only)**. Therefore, all Year-to-Date (YTD) comparisons show 2023 performance against the same period in 2022.

So the lower absolute 2023 total compared to 2022 is expected and does not indicate a decline.]

Question 1: How has the business performed in 2023 compared to 2022 and what is driving the growth?

What

Maven matched its **entire 2022 revenue of \$7M in just 9 months**. Transactions grew **37.5%** and units sold **40.8%**. But gross margin fell from **29.3% to 26.2%**, a drop of **-11.3%**.

Why

Growth is being driven by volume not value. **Toys dominate at 35.26% revenue share** but carries only **21.2% margin**, the lowest of all categories. As Toys grows faster than everything else it pulls the blended margin down. *(breakdown by category covered in Product Performance section)*

Recommendation

Revenue growth means little if margin keeps shrinking. Maven needs to **actively shift mix toward Electronics** (44.6% margin) without slowing volume. Even a small share shift could meaningfully recover profitability.

Question 2. Which store locations are driving most of the revenue?

What

Downtown generates \$8.2M, roughly 58% of total revenue. The next closest is Commercial at \$3.3M.

Why

That level of concentration in one format is a real business risk. One bad quarter for Downtown and the whole company feels it.

Recommendation

Airport stores lead on margin at 29.3% despite lowest volume. Before doubling down on Downtown expansion Maven should study what makes Airport stores more profitable. *(store format deep dive in Store & Geography section)*

Dashboard Page 2: Product Performance



This page breaks down performance at category and product level. It includes 4 KPI cards at top (*KPI's other than Top Product by revenue are static and reflects company-wide benchmarks*), a scatter plot mapping revenue vs margin, top 5 products by revenue & gross profit and a margin % ranking by category.

Question 3: Which products and categories offer the best balance between high revenue and high profitability?

What

The scatter plot tells the clearest story here. **Colorbuds is the only product sitting in the High Rev, High Margin quadrant with \$1.56M revenue and 53.4% margin.** That is exceptional. Lego Bricks has the highest revenue at **\$2.4M** but its gross profit is only **\$299K**, which signals a much thinner margin despite the volume.

Why

Lego Bricks is a volume driver not a profit driver. Colorbuds on the other hand earns more than **\$835K in gross profit** on \$1.56M revenue. That ratio is significantly stronger. Electronics as a category backs this up with the **highest average margin at 44.6%** while Toys sit at the bottom at **21.2%**.

Recommendation

Colorbuds deserves more shelf space, promotional priority and bundling opportunities. It is currently doing the heavy lifting quietly. **Maven should treat Colorbuds as a hero product**, not just a secondary line behind Lego Bricks. *(store-level product distribution explored in Store & Geography section)*

Question 4: Are we sacrificing margin for volume, and which categories need attention?

What

Toys accounts for 35.26% of revenue but carries the **lowest margin at 21.2%**. Meanwhile Electronics holds only **15.55% revenue share** despite leading margin at **44.6%**. The company's biggest revenue category is also the least profitable one.

Why

This is a classic volume vs value tension. Toys likely sells well because of price accessibility and brand recognition like Lego Bricks. But every time Toys grows faster than Electronics the blended company margin takes a hit. That is exactly what the **-11.3% margin decline** in 2023 reflects.

Recommendation

Electronics needs a growth strategy. Whether that's better placement, targeted promotions, or bundling with high-traffic Toy purchases, the goal is to grow Electronics revenue share closer to its margin contribution. Even moving it from **15.55% to 20% share** would have a meaningful impact on overall profitability.

Dashboard Page 3: Store & Geography



This page maps performance across all 50 stores and 4 location formats. It includes a store revenue ranking, a scatter plot categorizing stores into four quadrants and a stock out risk chart showing which stores are most exposed to inventory gaps.

Each store in the ranking also supports a **drill through to a dedicated Store Details page**, where individual monthly revenue trends, top 5 products, stock out risk table, and margin vs company benchmark are visible at store level. This makes it easy to go from network-wide patterns to store-specific action in a single click.

Question 5: Which store formats are the strongest performers and which ones are underperforming relative to their potential?

What

The scatter plot splits stores into four quadrants. **Ciudad de Mexico 2 sits in the Star Stores zone with \$554K revenue and 30.6% margin**, the strongest combination in the entire network. On the other end, **Guanajuato 3 is a clear underperformer at \$276K revenue and only 24.4% margin**, sitting well below both the revenue and margin averages.

Why

The gap between these two stores isn't just about city size. CDMX 2 is an **Airport store** which benefits from a captive, higher spending customer base with less price sensitivity. Guanajuato 3 is **Residential store**, a format that generally serves a more budget conscious local shopper.

Recommendation

Underperforming Residential stores like Guanajuato 3 need a category mix review. Pushing **higher margin products like Electronics and Games** over low margin Toys could help recover margin without needing more footfall. *(product mix strategy covered in Product Performance section)*

Question 6: Why do Airport stores lead on margin and is there an opportunity to scale this model?

What

Filtered to Airport only, the network generates **\$1M in revenue at 29.3% margin** despite having only 3 stores. Airport stores are doing **more per store with better returns** than any other format.

The category mix tells the story. **Electronics leads at 32.24% revenue share** in Airport stores vs being underleveraged across the full network. Toys drops to a much smaller share compared to the all-store view.

Why

Airport customers are travelers. They tend to buy on impulse, are less price sensitive and naturally gravitate toward **compact, higher value products** like Electronics. That drives margin up without any discounts needed.

Recommendation

The Airport format is Maven's most efficient and it only has 3 stores. Before expanding more Downtown locations, leadership should seriously evaluate **opening more Airport stores or applying the Airport product mix strategy** to other formats.

Question 7: Beyond network rankings, what does a top performing store look like at ground level and are there hidden operational risks even in the best stores?



What

Drilling into **Guadalajara 3**, ranked **2nd across 50 stores** with **\$449K revenue** and **\$160K above company average**, reveals something concerning. Despite its strong revenue rank the store sits at **27.1%** in terms of **gross margin**, **1% below** company average. And its stock out risk table shows multiple products **at potential stockout risk**, including **Lego Bricks** with **only 3 days of stock left**.

Lego Bricks is this store's **top product at \$69K**. Running out of it is a direct revenue risk at the store's single biggest earner.

Why

High revenue can mask operational gaps. Guadalajara 3 is clearly driving volume but the margin gap suggests either a unfavorable product mix at store level or some degree of discounting happening on the ground. The stockout risk on Lego Bricks specifically is critical because this store also sells **Colorbuds at \$57K** and **Rubik's Cube at \$49K**, meaning the top 3 products are all high velocity items that need tight inventory management.

Recommendation

Guadalajara 3 needs **immediate Lego Bricks restocking** before it hits zero. More broadly this store is a good example of why revenue rank alone is not enough to assess store health. **Margin and stock levels need to be monitored alongside revenue** not separately. The drill through capability in this dashboard makes that kind of check a one click action for any store manager or regional lead.

Dashboard Page 4: Time & Behavior



This page focuses on **when** customers are buying and how their behavior changes over time. It shows daily and weekly patterns, compares weekend vs weekday performance, monthly trends and reveals which product categories perform best in different months and quarters.

Question 8: What are the key weekly behavioral patterns and how can operations be optimized around them?

What

Saturday is the single biggest revenue day at \$1.39M in 2023. Revenue builds consistently from Monday through the week, peaking on Friday and Saturday. Sunday drops off noticeably. Even though Friday & Saturday dominates, **weekend revenue only accounts for 31.9% of weekly revenue** which seems low given Saturday's performance.

Why

The weekend share looks underwhelming because **Sunday significantly underperforms** relative to Saturday. The Fri-Sat spike is real and consistent across both 2022 and 2023 but Sunday doesn't carry that momentum forward. Customers appear to shop mostly on Friday evening and Saturday for leisure/gifting.

Recommendation

Maven should align **staffing, inventory restocking and promotional pushes to Thursday-Saturday** rather than spreading resources evenly across the week. Sunday could also be used as an opportunity — a targeted Sunday promotion or event could convert some of that untapped weekend footfall into revenue.

Question 9: What are the key monthly and seasonal patterns and how should inventory and promotions be planned around them?

What

The heatmap tells a clear story. **Toys intensity deepens from March and peaks across April, May and June** before fading toward Q3. March was the highest month at **\$883K**, April sits at **\$827K** and July edges it slightly at **\$828K**. Across all categories Q4 is visibly the lightest in color, the lowest revenue period in the dataset.

Why

This is not a coincidence. **April 30th is Día del Niño**, Children's Day in Mexico, one of the country's biggest retail events for toys and family products. Research shows it generated an estimated **\$1.9 billion USD nationally in 2024**, with toy searches peaking in the final week of April. The March to June intensity in the Toys heatmap maps almost perfectly onto that shopping window.

The Q4 dip needs important context though. **Maven's 2023 data only runs through September**. The dataset completely misses **El Buen Fin** (Mexico's Black Friday held in mid November), Christmas, and **Día de Reyes in January** where national demand concentrates heavily in toys and electronics. The Q4 collapse is a **data coverage gap, not a business failure**.

Recommendation

Two things. First **build Toys inventory from February** to capture the full Día del Niño demand window. Stores that stock out early lose sales they cannot recover. Second **Q4 planning should be the highest priority season** once full year data is available. El Buen Fin, Christmas and Día de Reyes together are the most commercially significant weeks in Mexican retail. Maven needs inventory builds, promotional calendars and staffing plans ready well in advance for that window.

Conclusion

Maven Toys is clearly in growth mode. Revenue is up **30.9%**, transactions have increased **37.5%**, and units sold jumped **40.8%** all in just nine months of 2023 data. On paper it looks like a big success.

But digging deeper shows some warning signs. The company is growing mainly by selling more low margin products. It is also heavily dependent on Downtown stores. And it is missing clear seasonal opportunities.

Three areas need real attention:

- Product mix needs rebalancing. Electronics delivers much higher margins but Toys still dominate sales. We don't need to cut Toys. We just need to give high-margin categories more focus and shelf space.
- Store performance should not be judged only by revenue. Margin and stockout risk matter too. Some high-revenue stores are running out of popular items way too quickly.
- Seasonal planning is almost non-existent. Mexico has major toy-selling moments like **Día del Niño, El Buen Fin, Christmas, and Día de Reyes**. Right now the business doesn't seem prepared for any of them.

If Maven acts on these points in the next 12 months, the story can change completely. A smarter product mix can improve margins without killing growth. Applying the successful Airport store model to other locations can create higher-quality revenue. And building a proper seasonal inventory plan around Mexico's actual shopping calendar will help capture more sales during peak periods.